

Zachary Butler

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To the hiring manager:

I started my career as a classroom teacher — college composition at Montevallo, standardized test prep for Kaplan — before transitioning into video production. At Cornell's Center for Teaching Innovation, those two paths converged: my title evolved from Video Producer to Instructional Media Producer as the work grew to include more of the instructional infrastructure that content lives in. The Program Facilitator role at the Argus Institute is the first position I've found that genuinely calls on both sides of that background.

I've built and delivered online learning experiences working directly alongside faculty and instructional designers. At Cornell's Center for Teaching Innovation, I co-taught an 8-week faculty development workshop on video-based assignments delivered through Canvas with Panopto-hosted content — developing curriculum, facilitating sessions, and troubleshooting platform access for participants. I also produced two substantial faculty-collaboration projects: a branching-narrative interactive video for a data science ethics course (*Nobody's Fault*), and a full update of an edX MOOC on smartphone engineering with a Cornell computer architecture faculty member.

I translate complex academic work for general audiences — and I've done it at scale. Over four years at Cornell, I produced 3–5 short documentary films per year profiling innovative teaching practice across the university: following Doug McKee's work in Economics, Natasha Holmes's physics education research, Gen Meredith's design of Cornell's Master of Public Health curriculum, and others. Each project required getting deep enough into the academic content to ask the right questions on camera and make the work legible to an audience without a disciplinary background.

I'm comfortable owning digital infrastructure that others depend on. At Lesson Zero Studio, I built the business's complete operational infrastructure from scratch: project intake workflows, digital asset management, and client-facing delivery systems. At Cornell, I managed the CTI media server. The Program Facilitator role adds registration and revenue collection at a scale I haven't managed before — I want to be straightforward about that — but I've worked with tools in that space (Eventbrite, Square, Wave for invoicing), and those are learnable gaps compared to the instructional coordination and platform management this role centers on.

I'm currently based in Laramie, Wyoming — 75 minutes from Fort Collins — and actively weighing relocation; the chance to work at the Argus Institute would make that an easy decision. I'd welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background fits what you're building.

Selected work samples:

- *Nobody's Fault* (Cornell Chronicle):
news.cornell.edu/stories/2023/06/teaching-ethics-data-science-through-immersive-video
- Transformative Teaching at Cornell: youtu.be/cNwFOf1NG80
- Lesson Zero Studio: lessonzero.studio/work

Sincerely,

Zach Butler